

Trello and Jira Comparison

Category	Trello	Jira
Ease of use	 Easier Drag-and-drop Kanban boards. No setup needed- anyone can get started in minutes.	Steeper Learning curve. Complex menus, workflows, and terminology can overwhelm new users.
Free version	 More generous Unlimited cards, 10 boards per workspace, basic automations, and Power-Ups included.	Up to 10 users free, but advanced features (roadmaps, reporting) are locked behind paid plans.
Project support	Great for task tracking, to-dos, and visual workflows. Ideal for small teams and coursework projects.	 More powerful Built for software development: sprints, epics bug tracking and detailed reporting

WHY WE CHOSE TRELLO

For our agile game development project, Trello was the right choice. Our small team needed to move fast. Trello's Kanban board let us visualise tasks, assign work, and update progress in seconds, with zero setup overhead. Jira offers more powerful agile features, but its complexity and configuration demands are better suited to large professional teams. Trello gave us exactly what we needed: a clear sprint board, simple task management, and more time to focus on actually building the game.

- Small team
- Fast setup
- Visual Kanban
- Agile sprints
- Free tier

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Ease of use – Trello wins here. Anyone can pick it up in minutes with its drag-and-drop board. Jira has a steep learning curve and requires configuration before you can even start working.

Free version – Both are free, but Trello's free tier is more accessible for a student team. Jira's free tier actually has more agile-specific features (like burndown charts), but they come with complexity you don't need.

Project fit – Jira is built for large, professional agile teams running long projects. For a class game project with a small team and short sprints, Trello kept things simple and visual – less time configuring tools, more time making the game.

Key takeaway for class: Trello isn't "worse" than Jira – *it's the right tool for the right scale*. Jira would have been overkill.